



Northbridge Community Alliance Advocacy & Community Issues FAQ

Internal Reference Guide – 2026

1. What are Northbridge’s primary advocacy priorities?

Northbridge’s advocacy efforts align with the 2025–2028 Strategic Plan priorities. These include improving food access and nutrition equity, expanding educational and youth support programs, strengthening volunteer engagement systems, and advancing data-informed advocacy rooted in documented community needs. The organization prioritizes mission-aligned local initiatives rather than broad national policy campaigns.

2. Does Northbridge support expanded local food access initiatives?

Yes. Northbridge supports initiatives that increase food affordability, improve supply reliability, and reduce geographic disparities in access to nutritious food. This includes municipal-level efforts to strengthen local food retail development, transportation coordination, and referral partnerships. Northbridge’s position is grounded in documented community feedback and internal program data.

Northbridge does not assert that any single policy change alone will eliminate food insecurity.

3. What evidence does Northbridge have regarding food access challenges in Eastview?

According to the 2024 Community Needs Assessment and the 2025 Program Evaluation Summary, Eastview has elevated participation in food access programs and documented transportation-related barriers to grocery access. Survey findings indicate that a portion of households report difficulty accessing affordable fresh produce within walking distance.

These findings reflect internal survey data and program participation trends and should not be interpreted as a comprehensive population-level study.





4. Has Northbridge demonstrated that tutoring improves academic performance?

Northbridge's 2025 Program Evaluation Summary indicates that participating students reported increased confidence in math or reading skills and that partner schools observed improved engagement among regularly attending participants. However, Northbridge does not collect standardized test score data and does not claim that tutoring participation alone directly causes measurable academic performance improvements.

5. What is Northbridge's position on volunteer certification standards?

Northbridge supports maintaining required safety and certification standards for youth-facing and food safety roles. The organization also supports streamlining onboarding processes to reduce administrative barriers while preserving safety requirements. Northbridge does not advocate for lowering certification standards.

6. Does Northbridge support statewide tax reform to fund food programs?

Northbridge does not maintain formal policy positions on statewide tax reform unless directly tied to documented programmatic impact and approved through formal governance processes. The 2025–2028 Strategic Plan does not establish a position on statewide tax restructuring.

7. What is Northbridge's position on national immigration policy?

Northbridge does not take formal positions on national immigration legislation. The organization's advocacy efforts focus on documented local community needs aligned with its Strategic Plan.

8. Has Northbridge proven that its programs eliminate food insecurity?

No. Northbridge's program data indicate participation trends and self-reported improvements among participants. The organization does not claim to eliminate food insecurity or to establish causal impact without formal evaluation methodologies.





9. How does Northbridge ensure that advocacy materials are evidence-based?

Northbridge's Content Integrity & Citation Standard requires that factual claims be traceable to internal documentation, that numerical claims include source attribution, and that causal language be used only when supported by formal evaluation evidence. When sufficient evidence is not available, the organization refrains from making unsupported claims.

10. Does Northbridge support environmental climate legislation?

Environmental climate legislation is not identified as a formal priority within the 2025–2028 Strategic Plan. Northbridge may engage in environmental issues if directly connected to documented programmatic impact and approved through governance processes, but the organization does not maintain a broad policy position on climate legislation.

